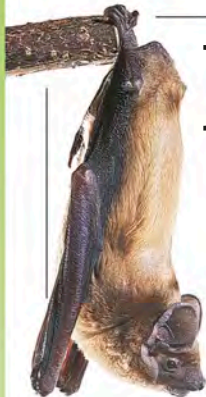


BATS



Bats are furry, flying mammals. Their wings are made of thin, leathery skin, which is stretched across their fingers like material over the spokes of an umbrella. Bats live all over the world, but you will not often see them flying. Most bats hang upside down and sleep during the day. They hunt at night. Most small bats eat moths and flies. Larger, vegetarian bats, often called flying foxes because they have foxlike faces, feed on bananas and nectar.

Acrobatic bats swoop through the sky at up to 40 miles (64 kilometers) per hour—fast enough to escape from owls.

The ears of this long-eared bat are almost as big as its body. It tucks them under its wings when it sleeps.

Bats hear better than all other mammals.

Mouselike, furry body

Wrist

Moth

This bat has caught a night-flying moth, which it found by listening for it in the dark.

Fruity bat

Jungles might not exist without bats! Fruit-eating bats pollinate plants, and the seeds they spit out or leave in their droppings can grow into trees.

The bat cave

Nearly all bats are awake at night—they are nocturnal. Sleepy days are spent inside caves or holes in trees. As the sun sets, millions of bats stream out of their caves to go hunting.

